- *Route*—This is identified by a unique ID, a collection of predicates for deciding whether to follow the route, a URI for forwarding the request if the predicates allow, and a collection of filters that are applied either before or after forwarding the request downstream.
- *Predicate*—This matches anything from the HTTP request, including path, host, headers, query parameters, cookies, and body.
- *Filter*—This modifies an HTTP request or response before or after forwarding the request to the downstream service.

Suppose a client sends a request to Spring Cloud Gateway. If the request matches a route through its predicates, the Gateway `HandlerMapping` will send the request to the Gateway `WebHandler`, which in turn will run the request through a chain of filters.

There are two filter chains. One chain contains the filters to be run before the request is sent to the downstream service. The other chain is run after sending the request downstream and before forwarding the response. You'll learn about the different types of filters in the next section. Figure 9.3 shows how the routing works in Spring Cloud Gateway.